```
  88  88              88                              88    ad88  88                  88
  88  88              88                              ""    d8"   ""                  88
aa88aaa88aa             88                                    88                      88
""88""88""   ,adPPYba,  88  ,adPPYYba,  ,adPPYba,  ,adPPYba,  88  MM88MMM  88   ,adPPYba,   ,adPPYb,88  ,adPPYba,
aa88aaa88aa  a8"     ""  88  ""     `Y8  I8[    ""  I8[    ""  88    88     88  a8P_____88  a8"     `Y88  I8[    ""
""88""88""  8b          88  ,adPPPPP88   `"Y8ba,   `"Y8ba,   88    88     88  8PP"""""""  8b         88   `"Y8ba,
  88  88    "8a,   ,aa  88  88,    ,88  aa    ]8I  aa    ]8I  88    88     88  "8b,   ,aa  "8a,   ,d88  aa    ]8I
  88  88     `"Ybbd8"'  88  `"8bbdP"Y8  `"YbbdP"'  `"YbbdP"'  88    88     88   `"Ybbd8"'   "8bbdP"Y8  `"YbbdP"'
```

```
888888888888
     ,88'
   ,88'
 ,88'
888888888888
     ,88'
   ,88'
 ,88'
888888888888
```

```
88  88  88  88  88  88  88  88
88  88  88  88  88  88  88  88
    88  88  88  88  88  88  88
    88  88  88  88  88  88  88
    88  88  88  88  88  88  88
    88  88  88  88  88  88  88
    88  88  88  88  88  88  88
    88  88  88  88  88  88  88
```

```
888b
8888b
88 `8b
    `8b
    ,8b
   ,8b
  ,8b
 ,8b
888b
8888b
88 `8b
    `8b
    ,8b
   ,8b
  ,8b
 ,8b
```

```
ad888888ba
d8"     "8b
Y8,
`Y8aaaaa,
  `"""""
      Y8a
      a8P
   ,8b'
 ,8b'
Y888888P'
```

STACKER SPORTS

IS THE *ORIGINAL*, *BEST*, AND *ONLY* SPORTS PODCAST

FOR BITCOINERS
BY BITCOINERS.

ENTROPY IS WHAT MAKES A BITCOIN YOUR BITCOIN.

2648 SATS \ 6 COMMENTS \
@RAW_AVOCADO 31 JUL BITCOIN

That's it that's the post.

```
                         88          88                                                  88
                         88          88                                                  88
                         88          88                                                  88
,adPPYba,   ,adPPYba,   88   ,adPPYb,88     ,adPPYba,  ,adPPYYba,  8b,dPPYba,   ,adPPYb,88
a8"     ""  a8"     "8a  88  a8"    `Y88    a8"     ""  ""    `Y8  88P'   "Y8  a8"    `Y88
8b          8b      d8  88  8b      88     8b          ,adPPPPP88  88         8b      88
"8a,   ,aa  "8a,   ,a8"  88  "8a,   ,d88     "8a,   ,aa  88,    ,88  88         "8a,   ,d88
 `"Ybbd8"'   `"YbbdP"'   88   `"8bbdP"Y8     `"Ybbd8"'  `"8bbdP"Y8  88          `"8bbdP"Y8
```

STACKER NEWS WEEKLY ZINE

ISSUE #67 960 671 JUL 25 - AUG 1

```
  88
  88                      ,d
  88                      88
88,dPPYba,   ,adPPYba,  MM88MMM    88,dPYba,,adPYba,   ,adPPYba,  ,adPPYba,  ,adPPYba,
 88P'    "8a  a8"     "8a   88      88P'   "88"    "8a  a8P_____88  I8[    ""  I8[    ""
 88       88  8b       d8   88      88     88      88  8PP"""""""   `"Y8ba,    `"Y8ba,
 88       88  "8a,   ,a8"   88,     88     88      88  "8b,   ,aa  aa    ]8I  aa    ]8I
88       88   `"YbbdP"'    "Y888    88     88      88   `"Ybbd8"'  `"YbbdP"'  `"YbbdP"'
```

Note from the Editor

I want to express my gratitude for the diligent and discerning of you who give back by what you post. You don't have to, you could keep your valuable understanding to yourself and, in some cases, be better off for it. Thank you for sharing what's important to you.

There is much that I find to be thankful for, not being hacked is one example.

```
  ,d                                                                  ,d
  88                                                                  88
MM88MMM  ,adPPYba,   8b,dPPYba,     8b,dPPYba,    ,adPPYba,   ,adPPYba,  MM88MMM
  88    a8"     "8a  88P'    "8a    88P'    "8a  a8"     "8a  I8[    ""    88
  88    8b       d8  88      d8     88      d8  8b       d8  `"Y8ba,      88
  88,   "8a,   ,a8"  88b,   ,a8"    88b,   ,a8"  "8a,   ,a8"  aa    ]8I    88,
  "Y888  `"YbbdP"'   88`YbbdP"'     88`YbbdP"'   `"YbbdP"'   `"YbbdP"'    "Y888
                     88             88
                     88             88
```

[500K BOUNTY] DEWHIRLPOOLER VISUALIZER

39.2K SATS \ 39 COMMENTS \ **@KRUW** 25 JUL COINJOINS

ZAPS FORWARDED TO **@NOPARA73** (10%)

See: *#1532477*

Whirlpool has worse privacy, fees, speed, and custody model than a regular Bitcoin payment:

-The privacy is worse than sending normal on chain payments because tx0 always reveals common input ownership and creates change
-The fee is worse than on chain payments because the victim wastes fees in tx0, wastes fees remixing sybil attackers, and wastes fees paying the coordinator (feeding the attacker)
-The speed is worse than a regular payment because you have to confirm tx0, then Whirlpool, then spend. Best case scenario 30 minutes.
-The trust model is worse than a regular payment because the coordinator can just steal your fees in tx0 and never whirlpool your coins.
Samourai's absence from the community unironically prevented Bitcoin from being destroyed. It is a downgrade for users in every possible category, see an example here: https://bitcointalk.org/index.php?topic=5482818.msg63551707#msg63551707

I had a fantasy about building a tool that shows your exposed Whirlpool data for a long time, but it would have been pointless since it would not include the xpub data from Samourai and the Electrum data from Sparrow. But now it is relevant since Ashigaru at least requires Tor, so a tool that tracks the on chain peeling that is built in to tx0 would be mostly accurate from a third party blockchain viewer perspective.

500k sat bounty to the user who builds this app/plugin for your Bitcoin node. This code is terribly outdated and inefficient, but it might help you get started on top of the Bitcointalk post: *https://github.com/nopara73/dumplings*

550 sats \ 1 reply \ **@Kruw** OP 1 Aug
SUBMISSIONS CLOSED
@clenchwallet I will test and review your submission. You will be awarded your bounty by the end of the week if it works!

[ZCASH EDITION] | | BITCOIN IS THE SHITCOIN KILLER

16.3K SATS \ 7 COMMENTS \ **@KRUW** 25 JUL COINJOINS

Some Bitcoiners aren't afraid to throw every shitcoin in the same "scam" bucket. Some Bitcoiners are afraid to challenge shitcoin narratives at all. This series, *Bitcoin is the shitcoin killer*, explains how Satoshi oneshotted the Bitcoin design, and the underlying reasons why predecessor coins were unable to duplicate its success.

TODAY, WE ARE SLAYING SHITCOIN NUMBER 16: ZCASH | ZEC | $483.46 | 0.0075 BTC | MCAP $8.1B

Zcash is a fork of Bitcoin's PoW & UTXO model originally designed by Satoshi. The variation is that Zcash deploys the "Zerocoin" protocol for theoretically perfect privacy. There are 4 sequential "shielded" pools where users can deposit their regular Zcash from the transparent chain.

So, why are there 4 pools? Why is there a transparent chain at all? Why did they create new tokens from genesis instead of forking Bitcoin to add their feature?

- The 4 pools are vestigial artifacts from bugs and upgrades. Zerocoin's zk privacy properties make it impossible for users to verify that counterfeit coins were not generated inside a specific shielded pool.
- The first pool required a "trusted setup" where 1 of n participants generate entropy and delete their toxic waste. We'll assume this was performed correctly, but it was an early criticism
- This pool had a bug responsibly disclosed, and silently patched
- Here is where you must have realized the purpose of the transparent chain: **Inflation on the transparent chain is detectable, and it bridges all 4 pools together**
- So rational holding occurs on the transparent chain, and opt in privacy occurs in, out, and within the shielded pools
- Pool 2 was killed by upgrading to remove the trusted setup
- Pool 3 was killed by a responsibly disclosed hidden inflation exploit, same as pool 1
- Pool 4 is still in development, so Zcash privacy is halted
- Oh yeah, and the shitcoiners who created the chain grease their hands by taking 20% of the block rewards directly from miners, by "consensus"

The reason the Zcash transparent chain is a boring variant of Bitcoin's purity is because the all the value should exist in the pools, and if the pool gets drained, then the transparent sister chain is a benefit for the attacker, not the victims. So now we live in a future where all the privacy concious people go broke, hackers get rich, and greedy dumbasses who use the transparent chain get protected.

2133 sats \ 1 reply \ **@Scoresby** 25 Jul

Do you think a similar problem exists with all zk stuff on Bitcoin (at least when amounts are shielded)?

Or do you think there are places in Bitcoin where zkproofs could be useful?

973 sats \ 0 replies \ **@Kruw** OP 26 Jul

1. I am not a cryptographer, but I prodded one who said yes: There is no guarantee of zk tx flow when you have complete anonymity
2. Why yes, thanks for asking: We use zkproofs all over different coinjoin protocols. Instead of putting the proofs on chain and making everyone verify them, you have a coordinator that constructs the zk ceremony for users to homomorphically commit their addresses to (okay fine I'll stop here).
   Counterfeit inflation never gets executed on the base chain because a zero knowledge bug in the coinjoin pool just looks like an invalid transaction. Nodes reject these transactions without even checking whether or not it looks like a coinjoin.

WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN A SOFT FORK, A HARD FORK, AND A CHAIN SPLIT?

14.8K SATS \ 23 COMMENTS \ @MURCH 27 JUL BITCOIN BITCOIN_BEGINNERS

This question cropped up a few times lately with some people referring to RDTS as a hard fork attempt. Let me try to define how I perceive the terms to be used in Bitcoin development circles:

Soft Fork

A soft fork is a consensus change that is forward-compatible to existing node software. The rules restrict blocks to a subset of what was permitted per the prior rules. Miners need to upgrade to be compatible, otherwise they might include transactions or build blocks that are forbidden per the new rules. Non-mining unupgraded nodes can follow along even if they are unaware of the new consensus rules.

The network will generally coalesce on the new rules, *if a soft fork is enforced by the majority of the hashrate*. If there are any blocks that break the new rules, they are reorganized out by the hashrate majority disregarding them.

Hard Fork

A hard fork is a consensus change that breaks forward-compatibility to existing node software. The new rules permit blocks that were rejected as invalid by existing node software. Only upgraded nodes can follow a hard fork, unupgraded nodes are either stuck at the fork height or follow a non-upgraded alternate chaintip.

Chain Split

Whenever miners are working on two or more chaintips, we speak of a chain split. This happens organically when two miners find competing blocks at the same height. It also happens when not everyone adopts a hard fork or when a soft fork is supported by a minority of the hashrate and network.

20 sats \ 3 replies \ @anon 29 Jul

So, in general, what should node runners be monitoring? Would one of the handful of major pools signaling immediately after the mandatory period begins be a sign to upgrade your node?

> 1023 sats \ 2 replies \ @Murch OP 29 Jul
>
> Assuming you are not operating a node that is transacting at a high volume, if you want to play it safe, just get any transactions you need to send confirmed before the mandatory signaling height and monitor the situation for at least a few hours when mandatory signaling begins. If you are running Bitcoin Core, your node will follow the heaviest valid chain and as long as you are neither mining nor transacting, a potential chain split would not negatively impact you.
>
> In the first few hours you should be able to see whether BIP110 suddenly got a huge increase in signaling. If the situation is unclear after a few hours, just lay back a little longer, I'm sure there will be plenty of discussion of what's going on.
>
> If you are running a lightning node, I would **not** recommend to depend on a BIP110 node as your source for the blockchain. If the hashrate distribution stays somewhat similar to the current, BIP110 nodes would likely fall behind and this could make you vulnerable to a channel being closed maliciously on you. If your node were to miss the unilateral close, it may fail to broadcast the justice transaction in time.

20 sats \ 1 reply \ @anon 29 Jul

What if you are mining? I'm assuming the same conservative approach applies - pause the operation until all the dust settles and upgrade to a signaling version if the major pools begin signaling within the first few hours?

> 102 sats \ 0 replies \ @Murch OP 29 Jul
>
> If you are mining, your choice is more complicated since you have an actual cost to mine, but your payout depends on the outcome. If you feel strongly about the outcome, you should mine in support for your preferred outcome. If you don't feel strongly, you could either guess what you consider to emerge as the likely majority chain and mine that for higher revenue, or wait for a while until the dust settles to save your cost of mining.

USER REPORTS THEIR COLDCARD WALLET BEING DRAINED ON REDDIT

21.7K SATS \ 159 COMMENTS \ **@MURCH** 30 JUL BITCOIN

The recipient address of the alleged hack has collected over 590 bitcoins in under an hour yesterday evening. One other reply in the thread saying it also happened to them, but the second one is spotty on details. I heard from another independent case, also a Coldcard wallet, but the situation is still developing.

Summary of Situation as of this Time

ACTION RECOMMENDATION: PLEASE CAREFULLY MOVE FUNDS STORED ON COLDCARD WALLETS CREATED FROM DEVICE-GENERATED ENTROPY TO UNAFFECTED WALLETS *ASAP*.

Any funds on a **COLDCARD Mk3 using a firmware from version 4.0.1 (March 2021) to 4.1.9 (latest version as of yesterday)**, where the entropy was only generated by the device, **should be considered compromised**. COLDCARD Mk4, Mk5, and Q are affected by the same issue to a lesser degree. Wallets generated by those devices are at risk of theft. Wallets that pair the device entropy with a strong passphrase or wallets created with externally generated entropy with at least 50 dice throws should not be exposed. If you used a weak passphrase and did not input external entropy (at least fifty dice throws), your funds are at risk.

Coinkite has released firmware updates for COLDCARD Mk3, Mk4, Mk5, and Q. Wallets generated with the new firmware should be secure. **Updating to the new firmware does *not make affected wallets secure*. Only new wallets generated with the new firmware are unaffected.** Coinkite put out a security advisory. The security advisory has been updated to include more devices, more details about the issue, and migration advice.

Block security researchers reports that the COLDCARD Mk2 is affected the same way as the Mk3.

Anyone with access to a frontier AI model is capable of reproducing the attack. Especially if you have funds on a COLDCARD single-sig wallet created with wallet-generated entropy, please carefully **move your funds to an unaffected wallet ASAP**. Single-sig wallets with a weak passphrase, or multisig wallets that can be spent by a quorum of COLDCARD wallets or composed only of COLDCARD wallets created with device-generated entropy should be considered at risk and funds should also be moved.

1341 sats \ 1 reply \ **@k00b** 30 Jul
update with complete timeline/story from reddit OP:
https://www.reddit.com/r/Bitcoin/comments/1vb6teq/wallet_drained_timeline/

371 sats \ 3 replies \ **@Murch** OP 30 Jul
Over 1300 UTXOs were spent toward the alleged attacker's address, and we have had multiple different reports, so it's likely that this affects a larger number of people.

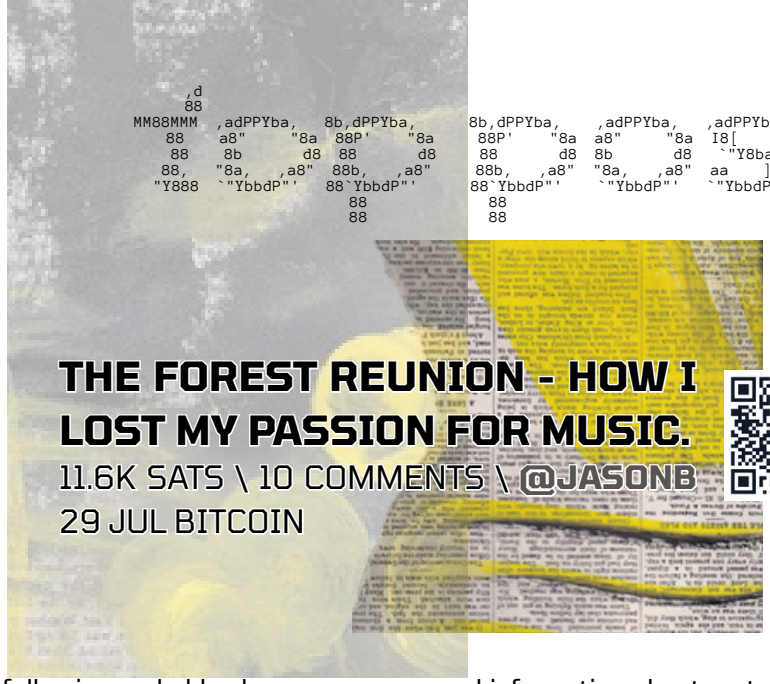
584 sats \ 4 replies \ **@didiplaywell** 30 Jul
Superbly fast and comprehensible coverage on the situation. Thank you SN community

783 sats \ 15 replies \ **@028559d218** 30 Jul
For those of you who can't or won't say it:

This is an absolute disaster. If Bitcoin isn't secure it is worthless. Multisig should not be necessary it is already complicated enough without multiple keys.

And it really pokes a hole in the whole 'hardware wallet security' industry, you might as well buy a laptop from best buy put linux on it download core and generate your private key that way. It's possible there are many, many users affected and it is quite bad.

"Hacks" like this are not acceptable.



THE FOREST REUNION - HOW I LOST MY PASSION FOR MUSIC.

11.6K SATS \ 10 COMMENTS \ @JASONB

29 JUL BITCOIN

The following probably shares more personal information about parts of my life than the reader may care to know. I'm sharing this as I wrote it as an honest attempt to strengthen the conviction of a potentially tired or jaded reader who believes in, and works toward bitcoin adoption for similar reasons to myself: freedom from unnecessary human control. I'm not quite sure how to make it less personal, and as this post will reveal, I don't reject all authority as a concept outright. Please be forewarned as, to some, either of those inclusions will certainly be more nauseating than the post if helpful, and I do value your time.

I got a rejection letter yesterday

It stung so hard. I am pretty sure that I know exactly why I lost this particular opportunity. It was the end of the second interview and the panel asked, "Can you think of a time when you enforced a policy you disagreed with? How did that play out? We're a highly regulated company and we have to enforce many policies involving KYC rules and other legal compliance."

This should have been my clincher moment. I was uncharacteristically nervous though. My phone (despite actually being plugged in) had just died, interrupting the interview for more than a couple of minutes, and I was feeling tense.
I reached in my mind for a period of time in which I enforced a policy that I disagreed with.

The following story is NOT how I lost my passion for music.

Covid

In late 2015, after much of my artistic and touring career had been on hold for a few years, I started a branch of a corporate party band company in a midwestern city. I recruited and trained a couple hundred musicians while also booking and managing a few events a month in another established city about two hours away. By the end of the year, I was booking and managing thirty or more events a month in the new city. That following year, I was tasked with bringing order to another neighboring city a few hours away in which the person in my position had been asked to step down. This experience was brutal, as I came in under high suspicion by the musicians, venues, and other vendors alike. For quite a while, everyone there was hostile. Within about a year and a half, that city was doing as well as mine.

When Covid struck, I was supposed to be on my first true, "do-not-contact," vacation in half a decade, yet I spent the first week harshly enforcing contracts, what I still believe was the correct call. This meant that the client was out of a 20% deposit, no small chunk of change, even for the wealthiest people in society. Nevertheless, it's how we protected our musicians, many with families and typically not the wealthiest people in society if they're working the wedding band circuits.

What I shared with my interviewers last week was what started with a phone call in the Denver airport in March of 2020. Despite building their business in a large swath of the midwest, I was instructed by my superiors to enforce their new policy about Covid related cancellations.

- First off, we are pausing all cancellation payouts for musicians. I was livid, but there was a silver lining. At least all of these high net worth people that had been yelling at me on the phone the last few days of my "vacation" would get their money and peace of mind back.
- Second off...well you probably already guessed it. We're still keeping the deposits.

So here I am, having made this company millions, enforcing the worst of both worlds. We're keeping the deposits despite the crazy circumstances and breaking our contracts with our contractors, despite our agreements to pay out some fees for cancellations. All this, despite my having built them an operation in the region that had made millions by this point. I made my opinion heard, gritted my teeth while enforcing this policy, and finally trained a few people to replace me after a few months.

The exact wrong response

So last week I said some platitudes about living in the real world and ended with this depressing tale, portraying myself as a pushover and a quitter. Both of these preparatives are, of course, accurate. But I still think my decisions reflected both my recognition of the proper need for authority and also the integrity to hold the line in the least destructive manner possible. Simply put, my track record trends toward radical, but not for the sake of being radical. I believe last week that I expressed the exact opposite of this in the way I framed this story.

```
                                                  88                                                  88
                                                ,d    ""                                            88
                                                88                                                  88
  ,adPPYba,   ,adPPYba,   8b,dPPYba,   MM88MMM  88  8b,dPPYba,   88       88   ,adPPYba,   ,adPPYb,88
a8"     ""   a8"     "8a  88P'    `"8a   88     88  88P'    `"8a  88       88  a8P____88  a8"     `Y88
8b           8b       d8  88       88   88     88  88       88  88       88  8PP"""""""  8b       88
"8a,   ,aa   "8a,   ,a8"  88       88   88,    88  88       88  "8a,   ,a88  "8b,   ,aa  "8a,   ,d88
 `"Ybbd8"'   `"YbbdP"'   88       88   "Y888  88  88       88   `"YbbdP'Y8   `"Ybbd8"'   `"8bbdP"Y8
```

< there's is more about music in this story, skipped here for brevity >

The response next time

I believe we need to be radical. But we also need to be effective. Bitcoiners love Hayek's famous, "sly trick" quote, but in practice we are anything but sly when dealing with the uninitiated. I want to do something radical, and I'm convinced this company is doing something radical. I want to see a more fair, just, and prospering world, but I don't think we get there with chaos. I believe in freedom and authority. When authority is abused, I don't jump to chaos as a response, but I want to fight alongside and for people that reject needless control. Now that we have bitcoin, needless control is what the dollar has become. I would like to be with an organization that is working towards dissolving that control.

The cross comes before the crown and tomorrow is a Monday morning!

The above quote is from Tolkien's friend C.S. Lewis. He's talking about even loftier ideas in the essay quoted (The Weight of Glory), but the point applies to this work as well. The past seven months have been pretty depressing for me. After going whole hog on trying to setup a bitcoin project last year, I'm back to playing local gigs. Sometimes it's so joyful. That's what the best music always is. Sometimes it's work. That's good too. But a lot of what I've worked so hard for has been consumed pursuing "bitcoin stuff." Maybe you've had setbacks too. If you have, I hope you remember what's so exciting about the opportunity this technology presents. If bitcoin succeeds in the manner that many on this forum hope it will:

No one will be in control of the money.

That's not just a clever approach that breaks the rules. That's something that will change people's lives. Maybe I won't ever get my bitcoin job. There are plenty of ways outside of a job to pursue this end. There are also other noble pursuits (some greater) which we should pursue as well. But that's a darn good one.

```
      ,d                                                                                  ,d
      88                                                                                  88
MM88MMM  ,adPPYba,   8b,dPPYba,      8b,dPPYba,    ,adPPYba,   ,adPPYba,   MM88MMM
   88    a8"     "8a  88P'    "8a     88P'    "8a  a8"     "8a  I8[    ""     88
   88    8b       d8  88       d8     88       d8  8b       d8   `"Y8ba,      88
   88,   "8a,   ,a8"  88b,   ,a8"     88b,   ,a8"  "8a,   ,a8"  aa    ]8I     88,
  "Y888   `"YbbdP"'   88`YbbdP"'      88`YbbdP"'    `"YbbdP"'   `"YbbdP"'    "Y888
                      88                 88
                      88                 88
```

CAN WE HAVE A SERIOUS TALK ABOUT THE LARP IN BITCOIN
12.2K SATS \ 65 COMMENTS \
@CHUNGKINGEXPRESS 1 AUG BITCOIN

I logged into X for the first time in a while to understand the post-mortem of how Coldcard was able to be attacked and the full extent of the threat. (Reluctantly, I really hate that place.)

Coldcard and [redacted] (AKA NVK) were supposedly one of the most respected brands / personalities in Bitcoin. The Coldcard was *the machine* you used to generate and secure your precious Bitcoin seed and defend it from an NSA covert ops team, or whatever.

The Coldcard was supposedly for *Serious People* and was the ultimate solution – everything else was an "inferior piece of shit".

Yet somehow, they were able to fuck this whole thing up so badly. The literal number one thing that a hardware wallet needed to do: to generate and store a secure seed, was botched so badly that $40million worth of BTC was stolen in half an hour.

The flaw in the Coldcard firmware is not obvious and involves the interaction between a few different files and config etc, but still - the error has been sitting right there for years. Some of the more serious people have commented that this thing should have failed safe and not done anything if it wasn't giving true entropy. Others have brought up the controversial move that CoinKite made from open source to "source viewable" - whatever.

I was never impressed by the aggressive and dismissive persona that this guy NVK projected online, however I have never met him in person and recognise that we live in the age of short-form video and algorithmic feeds – so you gotta do what you gotta do for clicks.

```
                                        88                                                  88
                                   ,d   ""                                                  88
                                   88                                                       88
  ,adPPYba,  ,adPPYba,  8b,dPPYba,  MM88MMM  88  8b,dPPYba,  88      88  ,adPPYba,  ,adPPYb,88
a8"     ""  a8"     "8a  88P'   `"8a   88     88  88P'   `"8a  88      88  a8P_____88  a8"    `Y88
8b          8b      d8  88       88   88     88  88       88  88      88  8PP"""""""  8b       88
"8a,   ,aa  "8a,   ,a8"  88       88   88,    88  88       88  "8a,   ,a88  "8b,   ,aa  "8a,   ,d88
 `"Ybbd8"'   `"YbbdP"'   88       88   "Y888  88  88       88   `"YbbdP'Y8   `"Ybbd8"'   `"8bbdP"Y8
```

But zooming out, it seems that instead of doing all those podcasts and conferences and taking swipes at genuine open-source projects, a serious project would have made sure that their product actually worked.

A real security / cryptography team and a proper business would have isolated that thing, run unit tests, done some sanity checking on the entropy, red-teamed their own system, and had many sets of eyeballs on that code.

But the thing failed, and I wonder if it is time for all of us to look in the mirror.

These kinds of people - and there are more of them out there, had the trust and the respect of a huge swath of hardcore Bitcoin enthusiasts.

Why?

I think it is because *they talk like a "Bitcoiner" and look like a "Bitcoiner"*?, but really it is a LARP.

There has been so much hate and anger in Bitcoin stirred up lately from these kinds of people, whether from the BIP110 crowd, general bigotry, and even some of the most cherished Bitcoin-only products.

It is all so tiring.

Some of these people are just simple minds. They want an ideology or an easy idea, an "us vs them" that they can play out in their mind and online that feels good. But hard reality is nuanced, economics, money and cryptography are complex topics.

The more nefarious and intellecutually gifted of these people use manipulation and snake oil to charm people into thinking that because "Bitcoin Only" or "no shitcoin inside" or "steak loving / freedom loving" that somehow what they say is right and what they have works properly. They speak the right shibboleths and go on the right podcasts to be anointed as OG.

I am adjacent to this. I am sure I've said some things that were not correct. I have my own *humble podcast* and have met my fair share of "influential Bitcoiners". There are many genuine people out there. I have met some very talented builders and nuanced thinkers. But more often than not those kind of people keep their voice down, they listen, they consider things deeply.

I have also met (or at least seen) my fair share of loudmouths and know-it-all Bitcoin influencers. They want followers - they want legions who will buy their shitty product or invest in their treasury company or something.

I have met their acolytes too, the ones who follow after every podcast, who doomscroll X, who repeat the shibboleths and are quick to use a *No True Scotsman* argument against anything that does not align with their prescribed worldview.

I once mentioned to someone like this, the most self-sovereign of all plebs, that I was running a Lightning node - do you know what they told me?

"You know that is a waste of time."

What are they all looking for? Something that gives them an identity in this strange tribe of ours?

What do you even do with freedom once you attain it?

They certainly don't want the detail and nuance and inherent compromise required of our messy fallen world – they don't want the nuance that *Pseudo Random Number Generation* is not the same as *True Random Number Generation*.

I long for essays on economics and political theory, of nuanced debate about elliptic curves that I cannot hope to fully comprehend. I pine for civil debate and actual insight. I thought the *Coldcard post-mortem Block did* was actually great and insightful compared to what Coinkite put out.

I feel like a bit of that lives on Stacker News and I have a few Bitcoin friends in real life who I can have long walking conversations with and trade viewpoint - but for the most part it is a sea of noise out there.

Whatever the LARP is in Bitcoin, I hope the fallout from Coldcard and the BIP110 washes away at least a bit of it.

– CE